

In September 2006, Apple updated its iPod, dubbed 5.5Gen, to a brighter screen as well as upping its battery life to a more acceptable six hours of video playback. This coincided with Apple's announcement of movie downloads at the iTunes Store. Apple also introduced the iPod nano second generation, encased in colours and upping the battery life to above 25 hours.

Apple also introduced the iPod shuffle second-gen, which was claimed to be the smallest portable music player. Super-small with a single 1 GB model, the iPod shuffle 2G is just half a cubic inch in volume and boasts 12 hours of battery life.

2.2 iPod Models

The current iPod line-up includes the iPod Video, the iPod nano, and the iPod shuffle.

2.2.1 iPod Video

The big daddy of iPods, the iPod video or just the iPod, has been one of Apple's greatest success stories. The salient features of this iteration include the 2.5-inch colour display, 30 GB / 80 GB capacity to hold around 20,000 songs or 100 hours of video. It can play music, photos, games and also integrates a search feature to easily find songs. A battery life of six hours of video and 16 hours for music is more than expected of such a small device.



The U2 edition
iPod Video

The iPod may not be the most feature-rich of portable media players in the market, but it is the simplest to use. One of the main reasons for the iPod's simplicity is iTunes. Setting up and managing music in iTunes and transferring it to the iPod can be handled by almost anyone.

Competition: Microsoft recently launched the Zune, slated as the newest iPod killer. It has a nice interface and boasts of Wi-Fi